

trol of an insurance company are still God's. As such, we will be held accountable for how they are spent (on us) just as certainly as if the funds came out of our savings account. As God's Word says, "The righteousness of the upright will deliver them, but the treacherous will be caught by their own greed" (Proverbs 11:6).

PROVISION

God's Word teaches provision, not protection. Insurance can be used to provide where a potential loss would be excessive. This is especially true when another's loss must be considered, as in automobile liability coverage. "A prudent man sees evil and hides himself, the naive proceed and pay the penalty" (Proverbs 27:12).

This point was brought home to me as I sought to insure our ministry buildings. A group of Christians had provided the funds to purchase our property which was to be developed into a counseling center. Even minimal insurance coverage turned out to be several thousand dollars a year. After seeking God's will, the answer became very clear. Certainly, if God was able to provide the buildings initially, He could also replace them if necessary. So the insurance money went to buy teaching materials. In deciding this issue, I relied heavily on the counsel of several other Christians whose spiritual insight I trusted. As I prayed about this decision, I kept returning to this Psalm: "Call upon Me in the day of trouble; I shall rescue you, and you will honor Me" (50:15). However, God does not want us to be foolish; He wants us to be "responsible." Later, as we were able to handle the costs, we did insure the buildings for replacement value. We were able to negotiate a package plan with a high deductible that significantly reduced our premiums and provided a good balance between current costs and future liability.

Too often insurance is used to shift our responsibilities to someone else. Between the government welfare programs and the growth of insurance plans for virtually everything, the Christian community has been duped into believing that they